

Gunman attacks motorists

Panicked drivers flee cars on busy Cambridge street; suspect shot after confrontation with trooper, civilian

By Travis Andersen, Nick Stoico, and Jessica Rinaldi
GLOBE STAFF
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CAMBRIDGE — A man armed with what authorities described as an “assault-style rifle” opened fire along Memorial Drive on Monday afternoon, randomly shooting at cars and wounding two drivers, sending panicked motorists fleeing from their vehicles, and triggering a massive police response along the bank of the Charles River.

The shooting unfolded about 1:20 p.m. near the River Street Bridge and along a stretch of the busy roadway, with at least 50 to 60 rounds of ammunition fired in a barrage of bullets, and it ended with an exchange of gunfire with State Police and an armed civilian, Middlesex District Attorney Marian T. Ryan said in an evening news conference.

“What happened today cannot stand,” Ryan said.

Authorities said that two men in separate vehicles suffered life-threatening gunshot injuries. Ryan identified the alleged gunman as Tyler Brown, 46, of Boston.

Two law enforcement officials briefed on the investigation said Brown is the same man who fired several gunshots at Boston police officers in the South End in 2020.

On Monday, Brown was shot in the extremities after a State Police trooper and the civilian confronted him and opened fire, Ryan said during a press briefing at the city’s Police De-

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JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

A swath of Memorial Drive in Cambridge was closed for hours as police investigated the apparently random shooting of drivers.

Fiancée of fallen state trooper reflects on their budding love

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

GEORGETOWN — After finishing his detail around 1:30 a.m. Wednesday, State Police Trooper Kevin Trainor sent a text, as he always did, to his fiancée, Jessica Ostrowski, letting her know he was headed back to their home in Georgetown.

She would be excited whenever he checked in following a late shift, staying up and waiting for him to walk through the door. The young couple often ended the routine exchange expressing their love for one another.

“You’re leaving that soon?” Ostrowski, 26, messaged back.

“Yes,” Trainor, 30, replied.

A few minutes later, her phone rang. There had been a crash. She needed to get to the hospital — to Kevin — right away.

Authorities say that when Trainor, a three-year veteran of the force, heard a wrong-way driver was barreling down Route 1 in Lynnfield around 2 a.m., the off-duty trooper answered the call. The decision turned out to be catastrophic. Seconds later, the errant driver slammed head-on into Trainor’s cruiser. Ostrowski rushed to be by his side at Massachusetts General Hospital in Boston, where Trainor was pronounced dead.

Those who knew him say the trooper never hesitated to charge into danger when lives were at risk.

TROOPER, Page A6

Brothers turn ghost sign into lively pitch from the past



PHOTOS BY FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Jack Williams (below) and his brother Eli are restoring the brick ad on one of the few West End buildings that survived urban renewal in the 1960s.

After some research and precise brush strokes, a slice of West End is reemerging

By Hannah Goeke
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Once you start noticing them, you can’t stop.

Ghost signs — faded, hand-painted advertisements from years past — can be spotted on the exteriors of brick buildings. The century-old traces of paint carry a sense of nostalgia in many Boston neighborhoods.

Now two brothers, muralists and sign painters from North Carolina, are breathing new life into a ghost sign on a building in Boston’s West End, one of the last standing after the neighborhood was largely demolished in the 1960s.

On a recent afternoon, Jack and Eli Williams stood on a boom lift at 90 Canal St., brushes and a can of white paint in hand. The pair have been working on restoring the historic Holt & Bugbee lumber company sign for over a week, letter by letter.

“We will take the time to not cover up

the paint, but go in and paint up to each individual line,” Jack Williams said. “So instead of starting with a blank canvas, you’re building it back from what’s already there.”

Starting around 7 a.m., the brothers strapped into their yellow safety harnesses. High above the sidewalk, they carefully painted the letters and then the negative space around them, alternating between green and white.

The painting process is just as much a part of restoring history as the finished sign itself, said Jack Williams.

“By doing everything by hand how it was done back in the 1890s, you’re ensuring that you’re still getting these human characteristics in the letters,” he said. “A lot of these signs are really wonky. But that’s how they originally work. And I think that there’s beauty in the fact that it was made by a person. Some may call them mistakes, but they add to the elegance of the hand-painted sign.”

SIGN, Page A10

Black critics of Wu direct frustrations to councilors

Demand they aggressively impede mayor’s proposals

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

It was billed as a town-hall-style community event, but perhaps felt more like a prosecution for the six Boston city councilors of color in attendance.

Seated in the front rows of an auditorium at Roxbury Community College one evening in April, the six found themselves on the receiving end of a grilling about their voting records and their stances on some of Mayor Michelle Wu’s more controversial initiatives that have angered parts of the city’s Black community.

“We have had enough as the Black community,” Mac Hudson, an organizer and Mattapan resident, said as councilors Ruthzee Louijeune, Julia Mejia, Henry Santana, Enrique Pepén, Brian Worrell, and Miniard Culpepper looked on. “If you continue on this path, we will work against you.”

COUNCILORS, Page A5

PorchFest turns into a lovefest, wedding-style

By Lila Hempel-Edgers
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The cheery yellow duplex on Hancock Street had already witnessed Sarah Welch and Philip Noonan’s first meeting, their engagement, and the adoption of Caolila, an orange tabby named for the couple’s preferred Scotch.

So it felt only fitting that they married there Saturday during Somerville PorchFest, as friends, family, and crowds of curious residents packed the street nearby.

“It was surreal, looking out and seeing all those people,” said Noonan, 37, a Spanish lecturer at Boston University. “It felt very full circle.”

The wedding became an unlikely centerpiece of PorchFest, the annual community festival that transforms Somerville’s porches, stoops, driveways, and backyards into makeshift concert ven-

PORCHFEST, Page A6

Clear, out

Tuesday: Sun early.
High 60-65, low 45-50.
Wednesday: Rain late.
High 58-63, low 51-56.
Weather and comics, **D5-6**.
Obituaries, **C9**.

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New Balance’s investments in Boston and in runners have paid off. C1.

